

I

(Acts whose publication is obligatory)

COMMISSION REGULATION (EC) No 2073/2005
of 15 November 2005
on microbiological criteria for foodstuffs

(Text with EEA relevance)

THE COMMISSION OF THE EUROPEAN COMMUNITIES, having regard to the Treaty establishing the European Community, and having regard to the hygiene of foodstuffs, and in particular Articles 4 and 12 thereof, whereas the following apply to microbiological limits.

(1) A high level of protection of public health is one of the fundamental objectives of food law. Foodstuffs should not contain micro-organisms or their toxins or metabolites in quantities that present an unacceptable risk for human health.

(2) Microbiological criteria also give guidance on the acceptability of foodstuffs and their manufacturing, handling and distribution processes.

(3) Article 1 sets out the microbiological criteria for certain micro-organisms and the implementing rules to be complied with by food business operators.

(4) The criteria apply to products placed on the market during their shelf-life. Sampling and testing follow the methods set out in the Annexes.